

AI Workout Plan Generator

Solo Founder Playbook

A focused, 90-day plan to build a freemium AI fitness tool — anonymous-friendly, ~10 hours/week, realistic path to €100–500/mo in 6 months and €5k+/mo in 12–18 months.

Niche	AI + fitness (intersection)
Format	Freemium web tool (free tier + €9/mo Pro)
Time	~10 hours/week
Skill match	Static HTML/CSS + Cloudflare + LLM API
Anonymity	Yes — no personal brand needed
Income goal (6mo)	€100–500 MRR
Income goal (12–18mo)	€5k+ MRR

1. Why this niche

2026 reality check

Things that **stopped working** in 2024–2026:

- Generic 'best-of' affiliate blogs — killed by Google's Helpful Content updates
- AI-generated content sites — deindexed in waves
- Niche review blogs without real expertise — Reddit outranks them all
- Dropshipping landing pages — margins gone, ad costs too high
- Print-on-demand stores — saturated

Things that **still work**:

- **Tools** (calculators, generators, converters) — Google can't replace utility
- **Programmatic SEO** (hundreds of templated pages for narrow queries)
- **Newsletter + audience** (community > SEO)
- **Specific affiliate** (B2B SaaS, courses) — high commissions vs. Amazon's pennies
- **AI wrappers** for tight, painful problems

Why AI + fitness specifically

Factor	Why it fits
Your skills	Static HTML/CSS + Cloudflare Workers + LLM API call = exact match
Anonymous	The tool sells itself — no face, no personal brand
10h/week	Enough to ship MVP in 4 weeks and iterate after
Search demand	"AI workout plan" gets 50k+ searches/month globally
Validation	Fitbod, Volt, Macrofactor, Cal AI — proven appetite
Web gap	Most competitors are mobile apps. A free web tool wins SEO + virality.
AI cost	~\$0.005 per generated plan via Claude Haiku — margins are insane
Money math	100 paying users × \$9 = \$900/mo. 1000 = \$9k/mo.

2. What the product is

A web app where users:

- Answer 5–7 questions: goal (lose fat / gain muscle / general), days/week, equipment available, experience level, any injuries
- AI generates a personalized **4-week workout plan** in ~5 seconds
- They can track progress and regenerate when plateaued
- **Free tier**: 1 plan/month, no signup required to try

- **Pro tier (\$9/mo or \$79/year):** unlimited plans, AI coach chat, progressive overload tracking, PDF export, multiple plan library

Why not the competing apps?

- **Fitbod** — mobile-only, \$80/year, friction (sign up + download)
- **Macrofactor / Volt** — also mobile-only, subscription-locked
- Most "AI workout" web tools are spammy AdSense blogs with no actual tool
- **Real gap:** clean, fast, web-based, try-without-signup — that's the wedge

3. First 30 days — MVP

Week 1 — Setup + landing page

- Buy domain (~€10). Candidates: **aiworkoutplan.com**, **gymplan.ai**, **liftgenie.com**, **wodforge.com** — check availability
- Build static landing page: hero + 'Generate My Plan' CTA + how-it-works + FAQ
- Deploy on Cloudflare Pages or Workers (free)
- Add basic schema.org markup (SoftwareApplication, FAQPage) — same playbook as Drilling Holes

Week 2 — Build the generator

- Cloudflare Worker that: takes form inputs → calls Claude Haiku API with a structured prompt → returns formatted plan
- Cost per generation: ~\$0.005
- Free tier: rate-limit to 1 plan per IP per month (no signup yet — friction kills conversion)
- Output the plan as a clean, printable web page with each week visible

Week 3 — Polish + first share

- Add 'save your plan' feature → generates unique shareable URL → drives backlinks
- Add email capture: 'Get your plan + weekly progression tips'
- Post in r/Fitness, r/bodyweightfitness, r/xxfitness — title: "Made a free AI workout planner — feedback welcome" (be honest, ask for critique)
- Drop the link in 5 fitness Discord servers

Week 4 — Iterate

- Fix the top 3 things people complain about
- Add the top 1–2 features people request
- End of month 1: MVP live, 500–2000 visitors, 0 paying users — **this is normal**

4. Days 30–90 — Monetize and scale

Add Stripe paid tier (\$9/mo or \$79/year)

Features that justify Pro:

- Unlimited plan generations
- Save and manage multiple plans side-by-side
- AI coach chat (Claude API conversational mode)
- Progressive overload tracking — auto-increase weights weekly
- Export to PDF / Apple Health / Google Fit
- Custom exercise library

Programmatic SEO (the slow burn)

Generate 50+ templated landing pages like `/workout-plan/[goal]/[equipment]/[experience]`.

Example: `/workout-plan/build-muscle/dumbbells/beginner`. Each ranks for long-tail queries that are easier to win.

Distribution channels (anonymous-friendly)

- **Reddit**: be helpful in fitness subs, drop the tool occasionally — not spammy
- **Product Hunt launch** around day 60, when polished
- **TikTok** with screen recordings (anonymous, just show the tool working)
- **Hacker News "Show HN"** if you frame it as a technical project
- **Outreach to fitness YouTubers**: "free Pro account for honest review"

5. Realistic money math

Month	Visitors	Paid users	MRR	Notes
1	1k	0	€0	MVP launch
3	5k	5–15	€50–150	First payers trickle in
6	20k	50–100	€450–900	Hits €100–500 goal
12	100k	300–600	€2,700–5,400	Approaching €5k goal
18–24	300k+	800–1,500	€7k–13k	Past €5k goal

These numbers are realistic, not hype. About 80% of these projects die around month 3 because the founder quits. **Surviving the dip is the win.**

Operating costs at €5k MRR scale

- Domain: €10/year
- Cloudflare Workers: \$0–5/month (free tier covers most usage)

- Claude Haiku API: ~\$50–200/month at ~10k generations
- Stripe fees: 2.9% + €0.25 per transaction
- **Total at €5k MRR: ~€300/mo costs → ~€4,700 profit/mo**

6. Honest risks

AI fitness is getting crowded

Win with execution speed and a great free tier UX. Don't compete on features — compete on friction.

Apple/Google might build it natively

Unlikely they'd ship 'AI workout plan generator' specifically. They build broad, you build sharp.

You quit at month 4

Biggest actual risk. 80% of solo founders fail here. Set a minimum 6-month trial before judging.

AI API price spike

Unlikely — LLM prices are dropping monthly. You can also swap providers (Claude → OpenAI → Gemini).

7. Execution checklist

Week 1

- ☐ Domain bought + DNS pointed to Cloudflare
- ☐ Static landing page deployed (hero + CTA + FAQ + footer)
- ☐ Anthropic API key created, billing set up
- ☐ Decide MVP feature set (write it down — resist scope creep)

Week 2

- ☐ Cloudflare Worker live: form input → Claude Haiku call → formatted plan
- ☐ Prompt tested with ~10 different goal/equipment combinations
- ☐ Rate-limiting by IP (1 plan/month free)
- ☐ Clean printable result page

Week 3

- ☐ Shareable plan URLs
- ☐ Email capture (ConvertKit / Resend / Buttondown — pick one)
- ☐ First Reddit posts (3 subs)
- ☐ First 5 Discord drops

Week 4

- ☐ Top 3 user complaints addressed
- ☐ Top 2 requested features shipped
- ☐ Decision point: do users actually save / share / return?

Month 2

- ☐ Stripe Pro tier live (\$9/mo)
- ☐ At least 3 Pro features that aren't in free tier
- ☐ First 10 programmatic SEO landing pages live
- ☐ Product Hunt launch prep started

Month 3

- ☐ Product Hunt launch executed
- ☐ 50+ programmatic SEO pages indexed
- ☐ First 5+ paying users
- ☐ Outreach to 20+ fitness YouTubers / micro-influencers

8. Backup option if you don't vibe with the SaaS path

AI tools directory (besttools.ai style):

- Curate 200–500 AI tools by category
- Affiliate links — most AI SaaS pay \$20–50 per signup (vs Amazon's pennies)
- SEO target: "best AI [category]" queries
- 10h/week → ongoing updates + 1 in-depth article/week
- Income trajectory: €200–€2,000/mo in year 1. €3k–€10k/mo in year 2

Less interesting than the SaaS, but easier to start and harder to fail outright. If you want a guaranteed €100–500/mo without product risk, this is the safer bet.

9. Next steps to commit

If you want to start this, decide on three things:

- **Domain name** — pick from candidates above or invent one. Check availability on Namecheap.
- **AI provider** — recommend **Claude Haiku** (better structured output, cheaper than GPT-4o-mini)
- **Start date** — block out the first 4 Saturdays. Treat them like a job.

Once those three are decided, the next deliverable is the **Claude prompt template** for the workout-plan generator and the **HTML/CSS structure of the landing page**. Both fit on one screen each.

Generated as a companion document to the Drilling Holes project — applying the same launch playbook to a new domain.